

Verbs

MOST VERBS ARE ACTION WORDS.

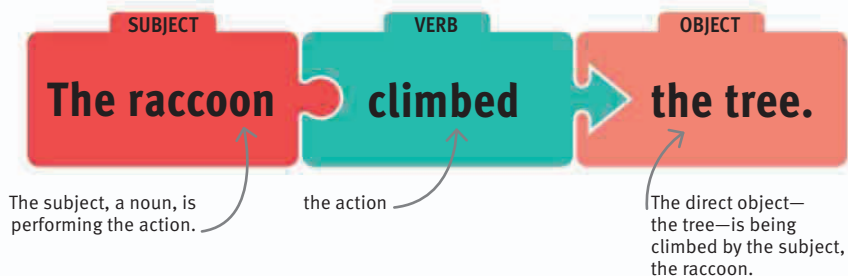
A verb is the most important word in a sentence; without it, the sentence would not make sense. Verbs describe what a person or thing is doing or being.

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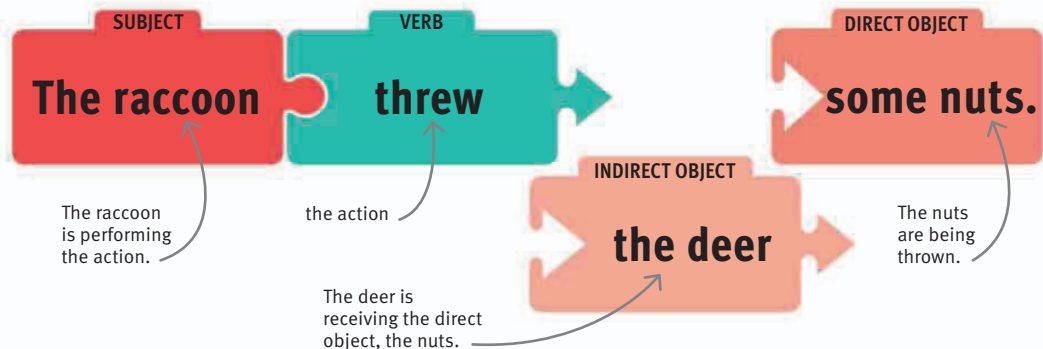
Verbs, subjects, and objects

All sentences require both a verb and a subject. The subject (a noun or pronoun) is the person or thing doing the action (a verb). Many sentences also have an object. The direct object (also a noun or pronoun) is the person or thing that is receiving the action.



▷ The indirect object

The indirect object is the person or thing indirectly affected by the action of the verb. It always goes before the direct object, and typically right after the verb. Indirect objects never occur without a direct object.



Transitive verbs

Action verbs can be divided into two types—transitive and intransitive. A transitive verb always occurs with an object. It carries an action across from the subject to the direct object. If you can ask and answer the question *who?* or *what?* using the verb, then it is transitive.

This object answers the question "What did the fire destroy?"

A fire **destroyed** **the forest.**

SUBJECT **TRANSITIVE VERB** **OBJECT**

Intransitive verbs

Intransitive verbs do not need an object—they make sense on their own. Common intransitive verbs include *arrive*, *sleep*, and *die*. Some verbs, such as *escape*, can be both transitive and intransitive.

Here, *escaped* is used as an intransitive verb—it makes sense without an object.

The animals **escaped.**

SUBJECT **INTRANSITIVE VERB**